

You need JavaScript enabled to use this service.

Cookies on Civil Service Jobs

We use some essential cookies to make this website work.

To understand how you use Civil Service Jobs and improve the website we'd like to set some additional cookies.

2150b2f075e395f5a48fedc34d5deffd.178132

Accept additional cookies

Reject additional cookies

1781328216-4f6de9bca1d063f35fde460d915

change
Language
121
BQsDAAAABgoESm9icwAAAAIwYWdlY2xhc3M
1224
yes
1781328216-4f6de9bca1d063f35fde460d915

Lead Developer Technical

Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 13th July 2026



Foreign, Commonwealth
& Development Office

Reference number

452037

Salary

£57,500

The starting salary for this role at Grade 7 is £57,500 (FTE) per annum. This is non-negotiable.

A specialist allowance of up to £9,200 per annum (non-contractual, non-consolidated and non-pensionable) may be offered based on the candidate's demonstrated skills, competence and experience at interview. This allowance will be subject to regular review and may be changed or removed with written notice. Location allowances will apply where staff are working in line with the FCDO's Hybrid Working Policy.

All future pay awards are subject to guidance issued annually by HM Treasury and the Cabinet Office.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Other

Working pattern

Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

[Location](#)

[About the job](#)

[Benefits](#)

[Things you need to know](#)

[Apply and further information](#)

Location

East Kilbride

About the job

Job summary

The Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office pursues our national interests and projects the UK's role in the world. We promote the interests of British citizens, safeguard the UK's security, defend our values, reduce poverty and tackle global challenges with our international partners. We employ more than 17,000 staff in 179 countries and territories, across our diplomatic and development offices worldwide, which consists of 282 officially designated Posts. Our UK-based staff work in King Charles Street, London, Abercrombie House in East Kilbride and Hanslope Park in Milton Keynes.

Digital, Technology and Security Directorate (DTaS) is responsible for delivering the Foreign Secretary's ambition to make the FCDO the most technologically integrated and innovative foreign ministry globally. This means harnessing digital, data, technology, IT security and information management to support the FCDO and UK Government partners on our platform to deliver our diplomatic, development and consular aims. All while keeping our people and information safe, especially from hostile actors.

The work we do is varied – from historical analysis and library services to cyber protection, from information rights to global network management, from supporting staff in using the latest Microsoft toolsets, to creating corporate applications, harnessing AI and much more in line with the FCDO Digital, Data and Technology (DDaT) Strategy.

The Directorate is made up of a wide range of talented staff and experts including specialist, contractors, home civil servants and diplomats who have served overseas.

Job description

This is an exciting opportunity to join the Digital Products and Services Department. We design, build and continuously improve digital products and services that enable the FCDO to operate effectively. Our work spans corporate functions and global platforms that support foreign policy, diplomacy and development aid.

As a relatively new team, we are building core capabilities to help FCDO become more digitally enabled. As we transition our internal systems, land new digital products and expand the scope of some of our existing digital platforms, we are building an expanded product function to design and integrate our products, spot efficiencies in existing processes and continuously improve our digital services to provide the best user experience.

As Lead Developer Technical you will be responsible for designing, running, and improving software that meets user needs. This involves writing clean, secure code following a test-driven approach and creating code that is open by default and easy for others to reuse. You will be expected to guide and mentor other developers, ensuring that best practices are followed and that the team continuously improves. You will also play a crucial role in setting the technical direction, making important decisions on software architecture, and ensuring that the software solutions are scalable, maintainable and aligned with the overall goals of the organisation. By leveraging their expertise, the successful candidate will help deliver high-quality digital services that provide value to users and support the mission of the government.

You will be part of an integrated delivery environment and ingrained joint working with policy and operations. You will have access to a tailored

Learning and Development offer, combining both Government Digital and Data Profession and FCDO subject matter opportunities.

Roles and Responsibilities

The successful candidate will:

- Provide technical guidance and direction to the development team. Helping identify appropriate technology and approaches and decide when software should be written.

- Mentor and support other developers, ensuring best practices are followed. Set technical direction and make the build vs buy calls.

- Ensure the quality of the codebase by conducting code reviews, maintaining comprehensive documentation and promoting best practices.

- Collaborate with product and delivery managers to define project scope, timelines, and deliverables.

- Communicate effectively with stakeholders to understand their requirements and provide updates on progress.

- Identify, Investigate and resolve technical issues that arise during the development process.

- Promote continuous improvement within the team by adopting new technologies and methodologies.

The FCDO also operates an agile workforce. To facilitate this, you may be required to undertake other duties from time to time as we may reasonably require.

Candidates who secure a role that is considered specialist/technical, may be required to affiliate to the relevant specialist network, if not already a member.

You may be required to travel in the UK with possible travel abroad, this will likely be monthly travel with any overseas trips agreed some time in advance.

Person specification

You must be a British Citizen at the time of application and, if invited to interview, you will need to bring proof of identity (British Passport/Driving Licence etc.) with you.

This role requires you to attain Developed Vetting (DV) security clearance.

For more information about this process, [click here](#). Attaining DV will require you to have been resident in the UK for five of the last ten years. At least one year of this must have been a consecutive twelve-month period. Serving overseas with HM Forces, in some other official capacity as a representative of His Majesty's Government or having lived overseas as a result of your parents' or partner's Government employment counts as UK residency for the purposes of security clearances.

It is essential in your application that you provide evidence and proven examples in each of the following Minimum Criteria, the Behaviours and the Technical question as far as you are able to do so. These responses will be further developed and discussed with those candidates invited for interview.

Essential Criteria

Demonstratable strong technical leadership with hands-on expertise across modern programming languages, frameworks, and tools, delivering high-quality front-end and back-end software that meets organisational and user needs.

Proven experience delivering and maintaining software using modern engineering practices, including continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipelines, automated testing, and deployment, to enable reliable and frequent releases.

Ability to lead, mentor, and support developers by providing constructive feedback, fostering collaboration, and building a high-performing, inclusive engineering culture.

Strong analytical and problem-solving skills to identify complex technical and delivery issues and develop effective, pragmatic solutions.

Ability to communicate complex technical concepts clearly and effectively to both technical and non-technical stakeholders, building strong relationships and managing expectations.

Ability to manage competing priorities and deadlines while working in agile environments, adapting quickly to new technologies and continuously improving team performance to deliver value to users.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Working Together

Managing a Quality Service

Making Effective Decisions

We only ask for evidence of these behaviours on your application form:

Working Together

Managing a Quality Service

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Developing Process Optimisation (Working Level)

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner Level)

Programming and Build (Practitioner Level)

Systems Design (Practitioner Level)

We only ask for evidence of these technical skills on your application form:

Developing Process Optimisation (Working Level)

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner Level)

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £57,500, Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office contributes £16,657 towards you being a member of the Civil Service

Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

25 days Annual Leave per annum.

9 days Public and Privilege holidays per annum.

See the attached candidate pack.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Ability and Technical skills.

Application Stage

You will be required to complete the following as part of the online application:

Please ensure that you allow sufficient time to complete the whole application process before the closing deadline.

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). CVs will be assessed against the Essential Criteria outlined in the Person Specification section above.

A **Personal Statement** of 500 words explaining how you consider your skills, qualities and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with specific reference to the Essential Criteria. These responses will be explored further during the interview process for shortlisted candidates.

The **Behaviours** you will be assessed on at the application stage are as follows:

Working Together

Managing a Quality Service

The **Technical Skills** you will be assessed on at the application stage are as follows:

Developing Process Optimisation (Working Level)

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner Level)

IMPORTANT: If you are applying under the Disability Confident Scheme and require Reasonable Adjustments in order to complete your application/online tests, please ensure Government Recruitment Service (GRS) are aware of this on the date of application and certainly by the closing date.

In the event of a large number of applications, we may conduct an initial sift by a lead Behaviour. Only candidates who meet the minimum standard in this will have the rest of their application fully assessed.

Interview Stage

Candidates will be required to give a 10-Minute Presentation at the Interview, and the topic will be sent to you in advance. The Presentation will test the following Technical skill:

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner Level)

You will also be assessed on the following Behaviours and Technical skills at Interview:

The **Behaviours** you will be assessed on during the interview are as follows:

Making Effective Decisions

The **Technical skills** you will be assessed on during the interview are as follows:

Programming and Build (Practitioner Level)

Systems Design (Practitioner Level)

Please note that the FCDO carries out name-blind (anonymised) recruitment to help build a more diverse and inclusive workforce. The personal information on your Application form and/or CV will be concealed during the sifting phase, and only the names of those who are being invited for Interviews will be made known to the Panel.

The FCDO has appointed the Government Recruitment Service to manage the process.

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service via fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

A reserve list may be held for a period of 12 months from which further appointments can be made.

Any move to FCDO from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems reading the Candidate Pack, such as through screen reader software, please contact our Team via fcadorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk and we will share a Word version of this.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure Scotland on your behalf.

However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing [Pre-](#)

EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

For further information on the Disclosure Scotland confidential checking service telephone: the Disclosure Scotland Helpline on 0870 609 6006 and ask to speak to the operations manager in confidence, or email Info@disclosurescotland.co.uk

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : FCDO Recruitment Team

Email : fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

The FCDO's recruitment processes are underpinned by the principle of selection for appointment on merit, on the basis of fair and open competition,

as outlined in the Civil Service Commission Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should, in the first instance, contact External.Recruitment@fcdo.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the FCDO, you can contact the Office of the Civil Service Commissioners.

